

HARLAN T WOOD

AI-CURIOUS ENGINEERING LEADER



SUMMARY

- 20+ years hands-on software development experience
- Ability to lead teams and projects
- Loves to dive deep into the code
- Passionate about improving quality with testing and CI
- Deep experience with Agile / XP / Lean
- Polyglot: picks up languages and frameworks quickly
- Cares deeply about improving the world through technology projects like [Trust Graph](#)
- “Harlan is an expert agile leader and software craftsman. He is gifted at perceiving business value, establishing processes to actualize it, and leading cross-team conversations to support it. He has an impeccable personal integrity that generates good will, good results, and good luck. I value any opportunity to work with Harlan and I recommend him highly.”

— Noah Thorp, CEO, CoMakery

EXPERIENCE

- Current
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2024
- Principal Consultant**
Heaven on Earth Consulting 📍 Remote
 - AI consulting and development
 - Open source AI interviewer
 - WASM LLM & voice transcriptions
 - AI voice-to-voice development, including OpenAI Realtime API
- 2024
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2018
- Principal Architect / Consultant / Tech Lead**
SharesPost / Forge Global 📍 Remote
 - Led development team, implementing GitHub Codespaces from scratch to reduce developer environment setup time from days to minutes, boosting team productivity and expediting new developer onboarding
 - Directed the complete migration of CI/CD pipelines from CircleCI to GitHub Actions, cutting build times, reducing operational costs, and streamlining workflow management by eliminating the need for a complex DSL, improving team efficiency
 - Trained and mentored team members in testing best practices, fostering a culture of high-quality code through consistent test writing and maintenance, accelerating issue resolution and improving code reliability
 - Established and enforced a content security policy for the Rails application, leading team efforts to strengthen platform security and protect against critical vulnerabilities
 - Spearheaded the adoption of Kubernetes and Tilt for reproducible, multi-cloud infrastructure, enabling seamless project deployments across diverse cloud environments and enhancing system resilience
- 2018
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2016
- Principal Consultant**
Nodesphere Studio 📍 Remote
 - Created the WorkNation prototype for decentralized, cryptographically signed workplace attestations with Cisco, Institute for the Future, and TrustGraph, leveraging UPort on the Ethereum blockchain
 - Built custom integrations with third-party paycheck provider APIs for WageConnect, enabling revenue generation through direct ADP integration in the Paycheck Workstream
 - Implemented cryptographic signing of JSON-LD data using Bitcoin private keys for BlockStream, advancing secure data transfer practices
 - Refactored a legacy codebase, added comprehensive tests, and trained developers for Zozi, helping to rescue the platform from maintenance challenges and ensuring long-term code quality
- 2017
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2016
- Cofounder & CTO**
CoMakery 📍 Remote
 - Built the code base from scratch, establishing a high-quality, well-tested infrastructure that became the foundation of a company that has received millions of dollars in funding, and is currently profitable
 - Architected and integrated ERC-20 token functionality, enabling seamless blockchain transactions within the platform
 - Built and managed servers for Ethereum nodes, ensuring reliable and decentralized access to blockchain resources
 - Led the architecture and implementation of a digital startup equity tracking system, providing secure and reliable infrastructure for managing startup equity
 - Developed a CI infrastructure to maintain robust test coverage and ensure consistent code quality, supporting scalability and future development

CONTACT INFO

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📍 Haiku, Hawai'i

SKILLS

- Lean Thinking
- Collaboration
- Communication
- Simplicity
- Pair Programming
- Automated Testing
- Mentorship
- Ruby
- Rails
- SQL
- Elixir
- Phoenix
- Python
- Java
- Rust
- TypeScript
- JavaScript
- Node.js
- React
- Infra & CI
- Regex
- Bash
- D3
- three.js

2016 2014	Staff Engineer Citizen Code • Led the tech team for American Express's skunkworks blockchain project inception, simultaneously building out open-source TrustGraph libraries to advance decentralized trust networks • Developed communication systems for i4j (Innovation for Jobs), enhancing collaboration and connectivity for this innovation-focused initiative • Collaborated with Nasdaq Private Markets to design and develop a trading system, delivering scalable infrastructure tailored to private market needs • Practiced full-time Extreme Programming, incorporating TDD and pair programming to ensure high-quality, resilient code across client projects	📍 Remote
2024 2012	Cofounder & CTO Superluminal Systems • Prototyped multiple iterations of decentralized collaboration system • Prototyped radial interfaces for visualizing and navigating information structured in arbitrary graphs • Engineered the Ruby on Rails backend from scratch, establishing a scalable foundation that supported seamless growth and data integration across multiple backend sources • Led the front-end and back-end developer teams, ensuring alignment on technical vision and achieving on-time project milestones with a cohesive deployment strategy • Owned the entire tech stack and deployment process, optimizing infrastructure with experiments on Fly.io and Cloudflare Workers to enhance performance and reliability • Directed AI project development, designing a custom classification system tailored to domain-specific needs, which provided a foundation for future AI advancements • Drove research in information visualization, leveraging Three.js and D3 to build dynamic data representations that enhanced user engagement and data accessibility • Implemented Stripe integration and streamlined subscription migration, improving user and admin experience simultaneously • Networked with thought leaders, visionaries, and developers working on related projects	📍 Remote
2012 2011	Director of Engineering Zoi • Directed a team culture that balanced software craftsmanship with business-driven deadlines, ensuring high-quality output aligned with strategic goals • Contributed hands-on to software development and system administration using Ruby on Rails, RSpec, JavaScript, jQuery, Jasmine, haml, and sass, supporting the team with technical expertise • Screened and interviewed a pipeline of developer candidates, maintaining a high-caliber engineering team to meet evolving project demands	📍 San Francisco, CA
2011 2010	Senior Developer Zoi • Developed full-stack applications using TDD and pair programming, ensuring high-quality code and fostering a collaborative engineering environment • Designed and implemented systems for automated server deployment, streamlining release processes and reducing deployment errors • Created and maintained information radiators, enhancing transparency and team effectiveness by providing real-time project insights	📍 San Francisco, CA
2010 2008	Senior Developer Planet Metrics • Developed full-stack applications using Ruby on Rails, RSpec, Cucumber, Capistrano, and cruisecontrol, contributing to robust and scalable solutions • Practiced Test-Driven Development, pair programming, and a full XP/Lean/Agile toolkit, fostering a disciplined and adaptive development process • Led retrospective and Kaizen meetings, driving continuous improvement and aligning team efforts with Agile principles	📍 San Bruno, CA
2008 2008	Senior Developer & Technical Project Manager Internaut Design • Led project management efforts, running retrospectives, planning meetings, and managing scope and deadlines with visual feedback to keep the team aligned and efficient • Developed significant new functionality for LinkedIn's core website, delivering high-impact features to support business growth • Built applications using Ruby on Rails, Capistrano, Vlad, RSpec, Shoulda, and cruisecontrol, leveraging a full-stack toolkit for scalable and maintainable code • Applied Test-Driven Development, pair programming, and XP/Lean/Agile methodologies to maintain high-quality standards and adaptability • Continuously realigned team focus on business value, ensuring client and internal projects prioritized impactful outcomes	📍 San Francisco, CA

INTERESTS

- Machine Learning
- Cryptographic Hashes
- Content addressability
- Neural networks
- Nvidia Jetson platform
- Visual programming languages
- Type systems
- Large scale data visualization

- Self-soveriegn Identity
- Collaboration systems
- WebVR / WebXR
- Trust networks
- Data visualization
- Decentralized social networks
- Blockchain for good
- Holochain

- Sustainable Development Goals
- Spiritual evolution
- Civilization 1.0
- Gene Keys

- Passionate about developer productivity
- Enthusiasm, flexibility, lateral thinking
- Open to change when a superior solution is available
- Questioning assumptions, openness to unexpected directions
- Committed to making luminous software experiences

2008
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2006

Senior Developer Wireless Generation

📍 Brooklyn NY

- Initiated and implemented department-wide unit and load testing frameworks with continuous integration via CruiseControl, establishing a reliable foundation for automated testing and deployment
- Provided technical leadership in build, testing, and metrics, elevating team practices and ensuring high development standards
- Managed junior developers, fostering skill growth and achieving effective solutions in challenging scenarios
- Integrated Selenium functional tests into CruiseControl, enabling test suites from any branch to run flexibly on any target server
- Created and prioritized internal development framework improvements within a lightweight task-tracking system, streamlining development processes
- Implemented unit tests using Behavior-Driven Development and conducted load testing with The Grinder, ensuring optimal performance and code quality

2006
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2005

Developer Evolutia

📍 Sydney Australia

- Coded, tested, and deployed the selective import of tens of thousands of sensitive prescription images into the live production database, ensuring data integrity and accuracy
- Initiated, designed, and implemented a custom error handling and reporting framework, enhancing system reliability and debugging efficiency
- Developed web and desktop applications in C#, meeting client specifications and supporting critical business operations
- Designed and maintained databases using SQL Server, Enterprise Manager, Profiler, and Query Analyzer, optimizing data storage and retrieval
- Built and deployed a system to eliminate duplicate orders in the live e-commerce database, improving transaction accuracy and customer experience

2005
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1999

Founder & Principal Consultant Golden Sun Solutions

📍 Sydney, Australia

- Marketed to and managed projects for diverse clients in financial services, government, training, and retail e-commerce, consistently delivering tailored solutions to meet client needs
- Designed and coded a Flash/PHP/MySQL ski resort booking system using Test-Driven Development, providing a reliable and engaging user experience
- Developed backend C# functionality for the Camera Store Metasite, including GUI components for seamless user interaction
- Created a C# desktop application for custom audio mixing, utilizing XML-based configuration to allow dynamic and flexible sound file management
- Dynamically generated Flash vector images based on user input using Python CGI, enhancing user interactivity and visual engagement
- Extended an open-source Perl shopping cart with a Python business logic layer, building a customized e-commerce solution for client-specific needs
- Built a database-driven ASP/Access/VBA solution for a tile shop, featuring a JavaScript-based cross-browser visualization tool to showcase an extensive product catalog
- Designed a Java desktop app to generate real-time tutorials from XML instruction sets, enabling scalable and adaptable training content

✓ RECOMMENDATIONS

- “Harlan is one of those too-rare people who can **see what needs to be done, how to cut the problem down into bite-sized pieces, and then knock the code out of the ballpark**. Both a pragmatic programmer and an agile project manager, I'd work with him again on any project that needs a guy who makes things happen!

— Christina Wodtke, Principal Product Manager, LinkedIn

- “**Harlan is a real leader and expert in agile development methodologies.** It was a real pleasure working with Harlan while at Zozi; he and I had some of the most effective (and fun!) pair programming sessions I've ever experienced. Harlan is focused on delivering value to the business in the most effective way possible. Harlan is great at mobilizing and managing teams, as well as in interacting with the non-engineering folks in a company, getting both groups into alignment and onto the same page. Harlan is also **extremely effective with the softer sides of software development; he's very in tune with team dynamics and morale**, and with the individual needs and concerns of the engineers on his team. Harlan is an extremely solid and proficient technical leader; I highly recommend him.

— Greg Woodward, CTO, Zozi

- “Harlan is a powerful developer with a heart of gold. I have talked often with Harlan about his desire to benefit society through his "superpowers" of programming, and to this end **he has spent much of his free time developing open source projects and protocols**. Harlan learns new technologies quickly and he works hard implementing what needs to be implemented. I would certainly work with him again given the chance and he would be a great asset to any development team.

— Duke Jones, Platform Architect, Good Money

PROJECTS

- YogaStream
- Heaven Sequence
- Smallest Federated Wiki (Ward Cunningham)
- Nodesphere
- Core Network
- Trust Graph
- Fork This

Harlan has been an amazing mentor for many years. He introduced me to the core principles and practices of Extreme Programming, skills I rely heavily on in my daily work. **Harlan cares deeply about people, and that shows in everything he does.** He's passionate about building excellent tech, implementing next-level best practices, and innovating towards the future. Some of the most exciting work I've ever done has been in collaboration with him.

— Jack Senechal, Principal Software Engineer and Team Lead, Mavenlink

Harlan **seamlessly integrates advanced programming techniques, human psychology, and extraordinary skills** into practical visions and projects. For any software or creative systems development, Harlan is my first choice for consultation, creation of a critical-path, and implementation of the project.

— Adam Apollo, Creative Systems Architect, Access Granted, Inc

Harlan is detail oriented and doesn't let anything fall through the cracks. He is proactive in getting his people together to have those tough conversations. Harlan is very much **an advocate of transparency and is able to report the appropriate level of information to the right people**, so they in turn can stay on the pulse of the project. Harlan has been fantastic to work with and I would be honored to work with him on a project again.

— Rodney Carvalho, Co-Founder, Internaut Design

Harlan's positive and friendly attitude combined with his experience with agile development practices make him a great team member on critical, time-sensitive projects. As a developer, his decision making process always focuses first on delivering business value, and keeping the team on track to **deliver quality, tested software**. He introduced many agile practices at Wireless Generation, leading the creation of the infrastructure and test cases for automated web acceptance tests. Aware of the challenges faced in **introducing change** Harlan created **highly visible project metrics** to keep product owners constantly informed of story progress and code quality. His friendly personality and creative energy always made pairing sessions fun, and I'd welcome the chance to work with him again.

— Daniel Wellman, Senior Software Engineer, Cyrus Innovation

Harlan was a progressive force in the company, promoting agile practices and **helping us improve the way we made software**. Harlan quickly developed an automated build process; In retrospect I don't know how we got by without an automated build. He set up code metrics, promoted unit tests, and a concern for developing high quality software. More than anything, Harlan brings a **passion for developing software the right way**.

— Gabe Yarra, Senior Software Engineer, Wireless Generation

Harlan's **intelligence, professionalism, talent and genuine interest in software development** not to mention his warmth, wit, and consideration for others - make him an excellent developer, and a pleasure to work with. His **considered, lateral and focused approach to his work is a true asset**, as is his ability to communicate very effectively. We were sad to see him leave to return to the US. I have no hesitation in recommending Harlan to any organization seeking a developer, and person, of very high quality.

— Rory Buck, Owner/Director, Evolutia Pty. Ltd.

Harlan is **one of the most intelligent and talented people I have taught in 24 years** of teaching at UTS. He studied a number of my computer graphics electives, where he was an enthusiastic and imaginative student with outstanding programming abilities. Harlan is an outstanding person who is friendly, outgoing, and articulate. You should grab him before somebody else does.

— Dr. Kevin Suffern, Senior Lecturer, University of Technology Sydney

I have an unspoken guarantee with Harlan that **when I bring him an urgent problem, it will be solved, every time**. I've come to rely on his speed and thoroughness. I've been able to call Harlan in at any stage of a project and know he will be able complete the job, cleanly and efficiently.

— Patrick Donohoe, Director, Peartruck Design

PERSONAL DEVELOPMENT

- Men's Leadership Council
- The Men's Passage
- Tangle Lab
- NLP Marin
- Mankind Project: New Warrior Training
- Landmark Wisdom Program
- Alison Armstrong
- Clairvision School
- Healing Theater
- Holotropic Breathwork

EDUCATION & TRAININGS

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|------|---|---------------------|
| 2012 | ● Core Protocols Boot Camp with Jim & Michele McCarthy | 📍 San Diego, CA |
| 2011 | ● Holacracy Practitioner Training | 📍 Philadelphia, PA |
| 2008 | ● Implementing Lean Software Development: Mary & Tom Poppendieck | 📍 New York NY |
| 2008 | ● ScrumMaster Certification Course | 📍 Cupertino CA |
| 2008 | ● Edward Tufte: Presenting Data and Information | 📍 San Francisco |
| 2000 | ● 3D Studio Max (200 hours) @ Computer Graphics College | 📍 Sydney, Australia |
| 1999 | ● Softimage (80 hours) @ Australian Film & Television School | 📍 Sydney, Australia |
| 2006 | ● Bachelor of Science, Computer Science (First Class Honors)
University of Technology, Sydney | 📍 Sydney, Australia |
- Computer graphics submajor: 3D game engine in C++/OpenGL, raytracer in C# (1.0 beta)
 - Extreme Programming course, including hands-on industry experience
 - Cisco Networking Certification



CONFERENCES

2019	●	RailsConf	📍 Minneapolis, MN
2019	●	Code BEAM (Elixir & Erlang)	📍 San Francisco, CA
2019	●	Decentralized Web Camp	📍 Pescadero, CA
2018	●	Rebooting the Web of Trust	📍 San Francisco, CA
2018	●	ElixirConf	📍 Seattle, WA
2018	●	Decentralized Web Summit	📍 San Francisco, CA
2017	●	Emerging Technologies Summit	📍 Denver, CO
2017	●	Rebooting the Web of Trust	📍 San Francisco, CA
2017	●	Crypto-Consciousness Conference	📍 San Francisco, CA
2017	●	Augmented World Expo	📍 San Francisco, CA
2016	●	Rebooting the Web of Trust	📍 San Francisco, CA
2016	●	Decentralized Web Summit: Locking the Web Open	📍 San Francisco, CA
2015	●	Coin Congress	📍 San Francisco, CA
2014	●	Internet Identity Workshop	📍 Mountain View, CA
2014	●	Hackadoge: Dogecoin Hackathon	📍 San Francisco, CA
2014	●	HTML5 Developer Conference	📍 San Francisco, CA
2013	●	Indie Web Camp	📍 Portland, OR
2013	●	Wisdom 2.0	📍 San Francisco, CA
2013	●	Internet Identity Workshop	📍 Mountain View, CA
2013	●	Startup Weekend Transmedia	📍 San Francisco, CA
2013	●	HTML5 Developer Conference	📍 San Francisco, CA
2012	●	Federated Social Web Summit	📍 San Francisco, CA
2010	●	Wisdom 2.0	📍 Mountain View, CA
2009	●	Startup Weekend	📍 San Francisco, CA
2008	●	RailsConf	📍 Portland OR
2008	●	Google I/O	📍 San Francisco CA
2007	●	Agile 2007	📍 Washington DC
2007	●	Continuous Integration and Testing Conference	📍 Dallas TX
2007	●	Singularity Summit	📍 San Francisco CA